

Cary Jones

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Senior Backend Engineer | Python &
Distributed AI Systems

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Summary

Senior Backend Engineer & Solutions Architect with over 15 years of experience architecting scalable **distributed systems**, high-concurrency microservices, and modern data processing pipelines using **Python** (FastAPI, Asyncio, Django, Flask) and deep **SQL data modeling**. Early adopter of **agentic AI development tools** (Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Claude Code) to accelerate delivery cycles while maintaining rigorous code quality. Proven expertise in deploying production LLM architectures (RAG, vector databases) with acute focus on latency, cost, and reliability trade-offs. Accomplished technical lead and Scrum Master proficient in mentoring engineers, driving architecture discussions, and collaborating cross-functionally with Data Science, Product, and QA teams.

Core Competencies & Technical Skills

- **Languages & Core Stack:** Python (Asyncio, FastAPI, Django, Flask, Sanic), SQL, Go (Golang), JavaScript (ES6+), React.js, Bash/Zsh
- **Distributed Systems & APIs:** Distributed Systems Architecture, High Concurrency, RESTful APIs, gRPC, Event-Driven Messaging, Microservices
- **AI & Agentic Workflows:** Agentic Coding (Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Claude Code), Production LLM Systems, RAG Architectures, Vector Databases, Prompt Engineering
- **Modern Data Stack & Databases:** SQL Data Modeling (Relational & Non-Relational), PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, AWS RDS, Apache Airflow, ETL/Data Pipelines
- **DevOps & Infrastructure:** Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD (GitHub Actions, GitLab CI), AWS (ECS, Fargate, S3, RDS, Lambda), GCP, Git Version Control
- **Engineering Leadership:** Architecture Reviews, Code Reviews, Mentorship & Coaching, Agile/Scrum Leadership, Cross-Functional Collaboration

Key Accomplishments

- Engineered event-driven distributed ETL data pipelines using AWS RDS, Fargate, and Airflow, executing mission-critical SQL queries handling **2.5M+ daily transaction events** with **99.95% accuracy**.
- Integrated agentic coding workflows (Cursor, Copilot, Claude Code) into software engineering practices, accelerating feature shipping speed by **40%** without sacrificing test coverage or reliability.
- Architected and deployed production-grade LLM applications and RAG vector search endpoints, optimizing chunking strategies and caching to reduce query latency by **35%** and cloud inference costs by **25%**.

- Mentored and coached junior and mid-level software developers through peer code reviews and architectural workshops, driving a **35% increase in sprint throughput**.
- Refactored legacy monolithic services into distributed Python microservices, cutting p99 API latency below **120ms** and achieving **99.99% system availability**.

Professional Experience

Principal Backend Engineering Consultant / Technical Lead

Jan 2023 – Present

Los Angeles, CA / Remote

CGJSoftware, Inc.

- Architect, build, and ship distributed backend microservices and data pipelines using Python (FastAPI, Asyncio) and advanced SQL schema design.
- Evaluate and deploy production LLM integrations and RAG systems, balancing inference costs, token overhead, and sub-second execution SLAs.
- Leverage agentic developer tooling (Cursor, Copilot) to rapidly prototype and deliver production features daily while enforcing strict peer code review standards.
- Provide technical vision and active mentorship to client engineering teams, establishing architectural patterns and distributed system best practices.

Senior Software Engineer

May 2023 – July 2023

CVS, Inc. — (100% Remote)

- Deconstructed complex legacy backend infrastructure into modular, distributed microservices deployed via Docker containers.
- Designed robust database models and caching strategies in PostgreSQL to support high-concurrency request throughput.
- Collaborated across engineering, QA, and business stakeholders to align system architecture with enterprise data processing goals.

Senior Backend Engineer & Scrum Master

October 2021 – November 2022

Disney Corporation, Inc. — (100% Remote)

- Architected high-scale backend services and relational data models processing enterprise financial analytics and real-time report generation.
- Authored complex SQL queries and optimized ORM performance, reducing background batch calculation times by **28%**.
- Facilitated cross-functional agile ceremonies as Scrum Master, prioritizing roadmap deliverables with Product and Data Engineering.

Software Developer & Scrum Master

April 2014 – August 2015

KeyIngredient — Austin, TX

- Designed backend REST endpoints and automated ETL processing workflows handling large-scale consumer recipe data ingest.
 - Automated data pipelines and validation routines, eliminating manual backend processing tasks by **90%**.
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Field Wireman & Communications Specialist

September 1995 – September 1999

United States Marine Corps — San Diego, CA & Overseas

- Deployed and maintained high-availability tactical communications networks in high-stress operational settings under strict uptime requirements.

Education & Certifications

Associate of Science : Computer Electronics

2010 to 2013

ITT Technical Institute — San Diego, CA

- Degree in Computer and Electronics Engineering Technology (GPA 3.67)